MinjokHerald

December 26th, 2017 | Volume 38, No. 1, 57th edition | Publisher KMLA Headmaster



10 Welcome, Ms. Francesca Lee!

18-19 Mr. Ganse's Hill and the Infamous GanHamDo Program

21 New Quotas in Courses - Can We Learn for the Sake of Learning?

민헤 2017-12 최종.indd 1 2017-12-20 오후 4:02:02

EDITOR'S NOTE

'Raise your words, not your voice. It is rain that grows flowers, not thunder.' This beautiful quote comes from the words of Rumi, a 13th century Muslim poet. We all have a book (or books) that we hold dear to our hearts—such books stir within us hundreds of emotions, compelling us to do unimaginable things and think unfathomable thoughts. This power of reading extends beyond literature to any piece —whether it be argumentative, explanatory, or persuasive—as readers explore the world at depth and shatter the glass that confines their thoughts.

I have always wanted to inspire readers through my words and sentences. I would undergo hours of deliberation before writing, running my mind through every possible topic I could write about. Maybe I could talk about the recent mess America has trampled into with the Trump administration...or about Italy's soccer apocalypse. Maybe I should settle for something dark and serious and deplore the shocking culture of sexual harassment in Korea, or ignored LGBTQ rights. Oh, forget it. I'll just go for something personal, and talk about my past experience—it never fails. I continue to suffer as I struggle to write the most inspiring editor's note in my Word Doc, only to press the backspace button in frustration a million times.

The truth is, it's hard to change the body and the mind. People say that the pen is stronger than the sword, but let's face it—quoting the words of Dillon Fernando, the head editor of Duke's student newspaper The Chronicle, the 'clear and unique ideas and perspectives reverberating through the ink' may just be nothing more than black blotches on the paper scattered on your desk. It takes immense talent to reverberate these ideas through the mind and let them transform you. Yet, we have hoped and strived for the best; we hope the heavy pages won't silence the valuable messages within. We believe in the power of reading.

Many years of academic writing have crushed our creativity, and reduced our reading to bare Sparknotes (this is supposed to be a secret). This edition of Minjok Herald revives a spark of that creativity, and lends a helping hand to readers drowning in the stream of academia. Take your eyes off your textbook—just 10 minutes will do—for a more relatable, enjoyable read. We proudly introduce to you the hidden corners of KMLA—so hidden that even a zombie won't discover you there. We also reveal the brand-new changes in KMLA, along with suggestions to change our school for the better. Though they may not be chicken soup for the soul, we expect them to be the herald of fresh change—both for you and KMLA.

Yoonjin Oh
Editor-in-Chief
Dec. 26th, 2017

민혜 2017-12 최종.indd 2 2017-12-20 오후 4:02:02

CREDITS

Editing Supervisor
Shin Seung-Keun

Editing Advisor
J.E. Seuk

Faculty Advisor
Neil Tweedie

Editor-in-Chief
Oh Yoon-Jin

News Crew
Park Sang-Yoon
Tak Ga-Hyun
Kim Soo-Min
Kim Seo-Yeon
Kim Hyn-Jun
Jeong Jae-Wan

Feature Crew
Jung Chan-Young
Jun Hyung-Jun
Lee Ji-Yin
Yang Soo-Jung
Youn Youn-Ji
Jang Hyun-Bin
Kim Ka-Eun
Yoon Hyo-Seo
Jung Seo-Ryn
Nam Hyun-Soo

Editorial Crew
Lee Do-Yeop
Ko Eun-ji
Bae Eun-gyul
Choi In-Seo
Park Ji-Yoon

Design Crew
Han Seung-Hyeon
Kang Myung-Kyung
Hong Seung-Wook
Kim Min-Ji
Yang Seok-In

Photo Crew
Kim Rak-Young
Cho Min-Ha
Lee Seo-Young
Lee Kyung-Muk
Kim Jun-Young

Sanpshots photos
Kim Yeon-Shin
Oh Seo-Young
Jeong Sang-Min
TTL Photo Crew
Sosari Project Team

TABLE OF CONTENTS

Snapshots 4

News

Remodeling the Shower Booths in the Deokgo House 6

An Addition to Student Uniforms : Lighter Overcoats 7

New Track Looking Fantastic 8

Interview with the New Teacher, Ms. Park Yu-Hyun 9

Welcome, Ms. Francesca Lee! 10

Feature

The Hidden Storage: Out of Sight, Out of MInd 14

Unraveling the Mystery of Underground Space at Chungmoo Hall 15

Surviving a Zombie Apocalypse in Changui Hall 16

Surviving a Zombie Apocalypse
in Chungmoo Hall Third Floor Washroom 17

Mr. Ganse's Hill and the Infamous GanHamDo Program 18

Editorial

School Facilities and Possible Dangers 20

New Quotas in Courses — Can We Learn for the Sake of Learning? 21

Penalty Points - Are they Heading the Right Way? 22

The New EOP Promation — Guess Who? 23

민혜 2017-12 최종.indd 3 2017-12-20 오후 4:02:03





SNAPS







민혜 2017-12 최종.indd 4 2017-12-20 오후 4:02:03





SHOTS







민혜 2017-12 최종.indd 5 2017-12-20 오후 4:02:04

Remodeling the Shower Booths in the Deokgo House

From May 24th to June 7th, the students' dormitory shower booths underwent a large-scale remodeling, which elicited mixed responses. While some were pleased to see their old bathrooms renewed with more modern booths, some questioned the necessity of remodeling, as many inconveniences were accompanied.

According to the facility manager of the Administration Office, Mr. Kim Ju-Min, the remodeling was indeed necessary. It had been an option continuously discussed for 4 years, and had finally been implemented this year. He asserted, "The purpose of remodeling was to enhance the quality of dormitory life for the students". He emphasized that the remodeling was necessary not only because it was vital to the students' hygiene but also because the shower booths had long been suffering from old age, dirtied and scaled.

Many students expressed satisfaction with the newly installed shower booths. 21st waver Kim Hae-Sol thinks that the remodeling was a worthwhile expenditure. "Before, when the shower booths were too old, cleaning them was pointless—the dirt would just not come off. The shower booths had to change at some point."

Despite the positive feedback, there were several complaints regarding the process of remodeling. During the two weeks of the remodeling period, students were forced to share the bathrooms of other rooms. Not only was this inconvenient when taking showers, but using the toilet was also distressing. The stall walls and doors were ripped off, completely exposing the toilet to other bathroom users. 21st waver Gu Ha-Neul remembers the embarrassing experience of using the toilet in the morning when all of her roommates were constantly slipping in and out.

Other complaints arose from poor cleanup. The bathroom was left dirtied and uncleaned after the construction; students were forced to clean up after the mess on the floor and the sink. 22nd waver, Park Ha-young, pointed out that the bathroom floor was so messy that shards of broken glass were littered everywhere.

These inconveniences seemed to send the message that the school did not prioritize students, as the remodeling could have successfully been done during vacation. Doing so would have eliminated all the discomfort, especially for students who were taking the AP exams during the remodeling period. Yet, Mr. Kim responded that remodeling the shower booths during GLPS was close to impossible due to multiple reasons. He added, "We thought that the students could bear the inconveniences for two weeks for the good of all."

Yet, the biggest concern wasn't the reconstruction itself. It was the result of the reconstruction that was concerning—the semi-transparent walls of shower booths. Due to its semi-transparency, students could see the silhouettes of their roommates using the toilet and taking showers, which caused more than little discomfort. Among the 60 students who participated in a student-led survey, 90% of the respondents confessed having felt uncomfortable while using the new restrooms. When the Executive Council requested to the Administration Office a solution to this inconvenience, Mr. Kim responded that tinting processes could take place, through careful deliberation.

The new shower booths are a definite boost in the quality of dormitory life for the students. Yet, there has been disappointment due to the several inconveniences that could have sufficiently been prevented. Many KMLA buildings and facilities are deteriorating since their construction 17 years ago, in 2001. They would have to undergo reconstruction like the shower booths at some point, before they start to threaten the safety of many KMLAians. Further remodeling processes, as well as active communication between the school and the students, will be necessary.

Senior Writer
Tak Ga-Hyun



민혜 2017-12 최종.indd 6 2017-12-20 오후 4:02:04

An Addition to Student Uniforms : Lighter Overcoats

On September 5th 2017, the 22nd wavers were finally given lighter school overcoats to wear. KMLA had previously allowed its students to wear private overcoats in spring and fall, as wearing noobis, KMLA's winter overcoats, would be too warm. The school declared an end to this policy not so long ago, as they mandated all 22nd wavers to buy the lighter overcoats. They have since then been wearing them, along with several 21st wavers who voluntarily bought them as well. The reaction towards this new policy has not been the best.

The biggest complaint stemmed from its expensive price tag of 12,0000 KRW. According to a freshmen-directed survey in September, 97.7% of the respondents complained about its cost. 60.5% were unhappy with the fit of the overcoats. Not only that, over half of the respondents wished for a change in design as well. Overall, a total of 74.4% expressed discontent with the new coats.

"Though the students have overall showed dissatisfaction about the coat, the school had asserted its need and how the project had been ongoing for a long time. "

Yet, KMLA has its own clear reasons for the creation of the new uniform. Mr. Kang Mun-Geun, who was the head director of the overcoat project, explained that the idea of lighter overcoats was introduced quite a long time ago. He noted that it wasn't until three years ago when the school started to allow students to wear personal overcoats. Yet this decision was merely a stopgap, as our school was planning to make a lighter overcoat that would suffice in breezy, chilly weather. Thus, began our school's long journey to create a new uniform.

Over the past three years, a uniform selection committee was established to select the design of the overcoat. Yet, the former headmaster decided to undergo some extensive reforms, which led to the creation of a new uniform selection committee last year. After his leave, the reformation project fizzled out, and the designs of the overcoats were again left up to the hands of the original selection committee. Their difficult journey came to an end this summer as they completed the designs and released the new uniforms.

Mandatory purchases were originally part of the plan upon starting this long journey. Mr. Kang explained that the overcoats would be added to the 23rd wavers' check list of uniforms to buy. Yet he additionally stated that their design and fit could change based on student and parent surveys, and encouraged the students to give continuous feedback.

In all, KMLA's long sought-for, ambitious plan finally came to an end to provide students with new overcoats to wear during spring and fall. Though some students remain discontented about the new change, there seems to be much room left for students to engage in active communication with the school to narrow down their differences. Hopefully, next year's new freshmen would view the new uniforms more satisfactorily.



Junior Writer
Kim Hyun-Jun

민혜 2017-12 최종.indd 7 2017-12-20 오후 4:02:04

New Track Looking Fantastic

KMLA has recently transformed through a recent remodeling of its track, from September 23rd to September 30th. Thankfully, many teachers and students seem satisfied with the air of newness the remodeling has brought along.

According to the Gangwon-do Office of Education, safety issues were the reason behind the remodeling. Too much lead, above the standard amount, was discovered in the urethane tracks, which gave the school no choice but to rip them off and renew them. This created considerable discomfort for the students, as they could not use the tracks for nearly a year. Not only that, the KMLA Family Sports Day had to be held in the gym, resulting in the cancellation of many entertaining programs. KMLA requested support funds from the Office of Education—they arrived soon for KMLA to replace the old track.

What kind of changes were made? First of all, the track was completely renewed. The old track was not only threatening the health of students and teachers, but was also aesthetically unpleasant due to its dirty, blotched color. Also, pieces of urethane were already breaking off from the surface of the track, rendering them quite dangerous for students who could fall down. Thanks to the renewal, the track is now as good as new.

Adding to this merit, a new basketball court was constructed. Before the construction, students were only able to play soccer in the field surrounded by the track. If they wanted to play basketball, they would have to climb their way up to the gym. Due to this inconvenience, some students demanded additional sports facilities near Dasan and Chungmoo Halls. The school considered different kinds of sports facilities, finally deciding upon the construction of a basketball court. Thanks to this decision, two basketball hoops have been placed, with court lines drawn as well. The ground surface of the court has also been made from softer materials than asphalt, providing students with additional safety. Now, students are able to play basketball during break times due to the proximity of the courts near Dasan and Chungmoo Halls. Not only that, students are now able to play basketball even during morning exercise as well.

"the school is expecting students to play more sports and exercise"

With the new track, KMLA hopes to encourage students to exercise and play more sports. So far, it certainly does seem to have an effect. KMLA is also considering additional methods to make better usage of the track and increase student satisfaction. What's clear is this: students definitely love the change and are eagerly waiting for more.

Junior Writer
Jeong Jae-Wan



민혜 2017-12 최종.indd 8 2017-12-20 오후 4:02:04

Interview with the New Teacher, Ms. Park Yu-Hyun

Please introduce yourself!

My name is Park Yu-Hyun. I'm a graduate student studying Modern Prose Education, or Modern Literature Education, in the Education Department of Seoul National University. I'm in my fourth semester of my master's program. I will go back to my graduate school to write my graduation thesis after a semester here with the students. I will have to agonize over what I will do after writing my thesis—whether to go for a doctorate degree or to work as a teacher in school. I enjoy playing baseball, as I mentioned in my first class. I also like jokes and playing pranks too.

Could you tell us what made you apply as a Korean Language teacher of KMLA despite your short one-year stay?

Well above anything else, the timing was great. I was planning to take some time off from graduate school. That was when Mr. Kwon, a senior in my school, asked me to work as a teacher in KMLA for a semester, as the original Korean language teacher had taken time off from work. So, though I primarily planned to go on a trip, I decided to cancel it and come here instead. Making this decision, I thought that the trip could always be postponed for later, while I would never again get the chance to teach at KMLA. I was also interested in this school ever since I was a high school student, because I wanted to study here as well. I have never regretted the decision to come here.

"I want KMLA students to have pride, but along with modesty."

What was your first impression of the KMLA students?

All students, regardless of age, bow to me well even though they don't know me. Also, although this is somewhat embarrassing, I was impressed to see that no one steps on my shoes on the stepping stone outside my office when they come in and out. I could see how the students were really polite. Not only that, I was impressed that the students tried to concentrate by "shush"ing each other when they talked too loudly. It was surprising to see that they made the voluntary effort to concentrate in class and create a quiet and concentrative atmosphere before I even told them to

What do you want to achieve in KMLA during your stay?

I, as a teacher, am only able to meet the students during Korean Language classes. But I want to know more about their everyday lives—for example, how dormitories look like, and how the students spend their self-study periods. I am also curious to see what morning exercise is like. I will certainly join morning exercise before leaving KMLA. I hope to see new sides of students during these non-class times, so I very much want to spend everyday life with them.

How do you think KMLA is different from other schools?

The most impressive part was the students' participation in class. My ideal class is a class in which students talk more than the teacher and construct knowledge in their unique ways. I think that this works well in KMLA. Also, the biggest difference from other schools is that there are a few students in a single class. I think this is the beginning of high-performance academic results in KMLA. Since there are a few students in one class, more communication takes places between between the teacher and students, along with smoother communication between peers as well.

What do you hope from the students of KMLA?

I also graduated from a similar high school, so I too feel that studying at a school like KMLA is a rewarding experience. Once we graduate, this experience really is something, something that people think is awesome. Spending 3 years at KMLA and graduating may be impressive and incredible for people outside of this school, but we must also realize that this isn't the greatest feat. Having KMLA pride is natural, but students must know that they cannot be defined by what school they graduate from. I want KMLA students to have pride, but along with modesty.

Junior Writer
Kim Seo-Yeon

민혜 2017-12 최종.indd 9 2017-12-20 오후 4:02:04

Welcome, Ms. Francesca Lee!

With the start of the second semester of 2017, KMLA greeted a new art teacher, Miss Francesca Lee. Fortunately, Minjok Herald had the opportunity to have an interview with her on herself, her views on KMLA, and plans as a KMLAian.

Please introduce yourself!

Hi! I'm Francesca Lee. I was born in Korea and immigrated to America when I was seven years old, where I studied from first grade all the way to graduate school. There, I received a bachelor in fine arts, majoring in painting. Now, in KMLA, I teach all art classes, including basic molding, media art, AP studio art, and senior thesis art. I love all aspects of art, so I constantly visit museums or look up about art to keep up to date with the art world. I also love listening to various kinds of music, watching movies, reading, and traveling around.

Why did you decide to teach in KMLA?

I had always thought of returning to my hometown from America, and the uniqueness of KMLA attracted me. I believe KMLA is really one of a kind. Students come from many backgrounds, and live in a co-ed dorm school in such a remote area. They wear their beautiful hanbok uniform while attending English classes, which seems to imply the school motto of looking internationally with tradition in mind. All in all, I wondered what it would be like to work with students in such a unique school.

"I hope that by the end of the semester, students can **grow**."

What do you think of KMLA and KMLA life so far?

Considering my previous American students, it is surprising that students greeting teachers is a common practice here. The students are all so respectful, and though it is new, it feels very warm and welcoming. I also like how the students here are all interested in a certain field, and have curiosity toward what they are learning. The morning assembly is always a pleasant experience, too. Seeing students of all grades come together with the teachers makes me realize that the school I am working in is like one small community.

Can you briefly explain how you plan to teach in KMLA?

I suppose my teaching style came from my university education. I learned that 90% of artwork is done in the planning stage, and executing is only 10%. Since I see my students only twice a week at most, I wish to spend most of class time as time for students to thoroughly plan and execute their work. I also hope to hold critique and writing sessions for each project. Art is not just about producing – critique is a form of presenting your artwork, and it is important to articulate what you have. It is true that students might feel sad or mad depending on the class's comments on their artwork, but I try to keep a positive atmosphere.

What do you wish to accomplish as a teacher in KMLA?

I hope that by the end of the semester, students can "grow." Whether it is big or small, whether it is about art or about themselves – I hope they make their own growth development. I have met many students who say they cannot draw well, but they seem to believe that "good" artwork should be "realistic." Yet drawing realistically is just one form of art, and everybody has their own style. I hope students can find theirs. Furthermore, I hope students learn to integrate lots of things in art. There is indeed a world called the "art world," which I plan to introduce to you one by one through various artists. But more importantly, this "art world" is closer to us than we think it is. Movie posters, landmarks, furniture... All of those are art. I hope students can understand that anybody can plunge in that world.

Lastly, is there anything you want to tell the students or staff in KMLA?

I'm super excited! I'm looking forward to work with many different types of students, since the students are what mainly drove me here. To my students, I want to tell them to cultivate courage. It is okay to fail. I think students here have lots of stress for perfection, and perhaps that is an inevitable result of such high anticipation they get. But, failing is acceptable as a part of learning. Being a student is having your last chance to fail. What is important is not doing things perfectly, getting good grades, nor meeting up to someone else's standards- it is continuing to try to learn every day. Never be stuck in what you have done. Look towards what you are going to do next.

Thank you for your precious time, and welcome to KMLA!

Junior Writer
Kim Soo-Min

민혜 2017-12 최종.indd 10 2017-12-20 오후 4:02:04

"I want
KMLA students to
have pride,
but along with
modesty."

Ms. Park Yu-Hyun





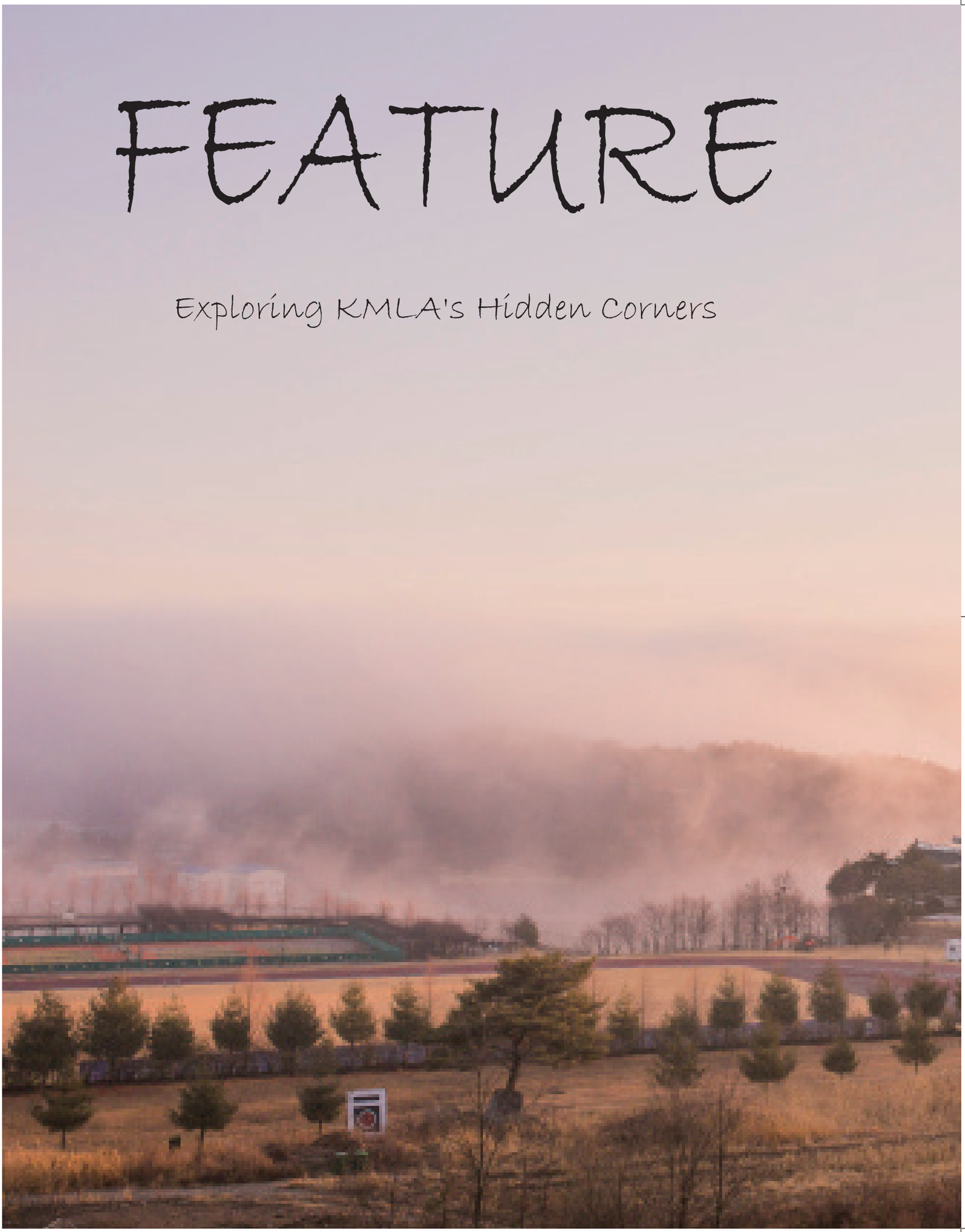
"I hope that
by the end of the
semester,
students can grow."

Ms. Francesca Lee

민혜 2017-12 최종.indd 11 2017-12-20 오후 4:02:04

FEATURE

Exploring KMLA's Hidden Corners



Gazing out the window from the eleventh floor study hall on a sunny evening, we relish the beauty that our large campus has to offer. Boasting a campus size of over 300 acres, KMLA prides itself on the open environment that it offers to its students. Yet among the 300 acres are several hidden corners that people hardly set foot in: from unused toilets to underground passageways, several sites remain yet to be brought back to life by the school management. In this Minjok Herald feature, "Exploring KMLA's hidden corners", we explore some of our campus' least known sites to pay due respect to the forgotten sections of our grounds.

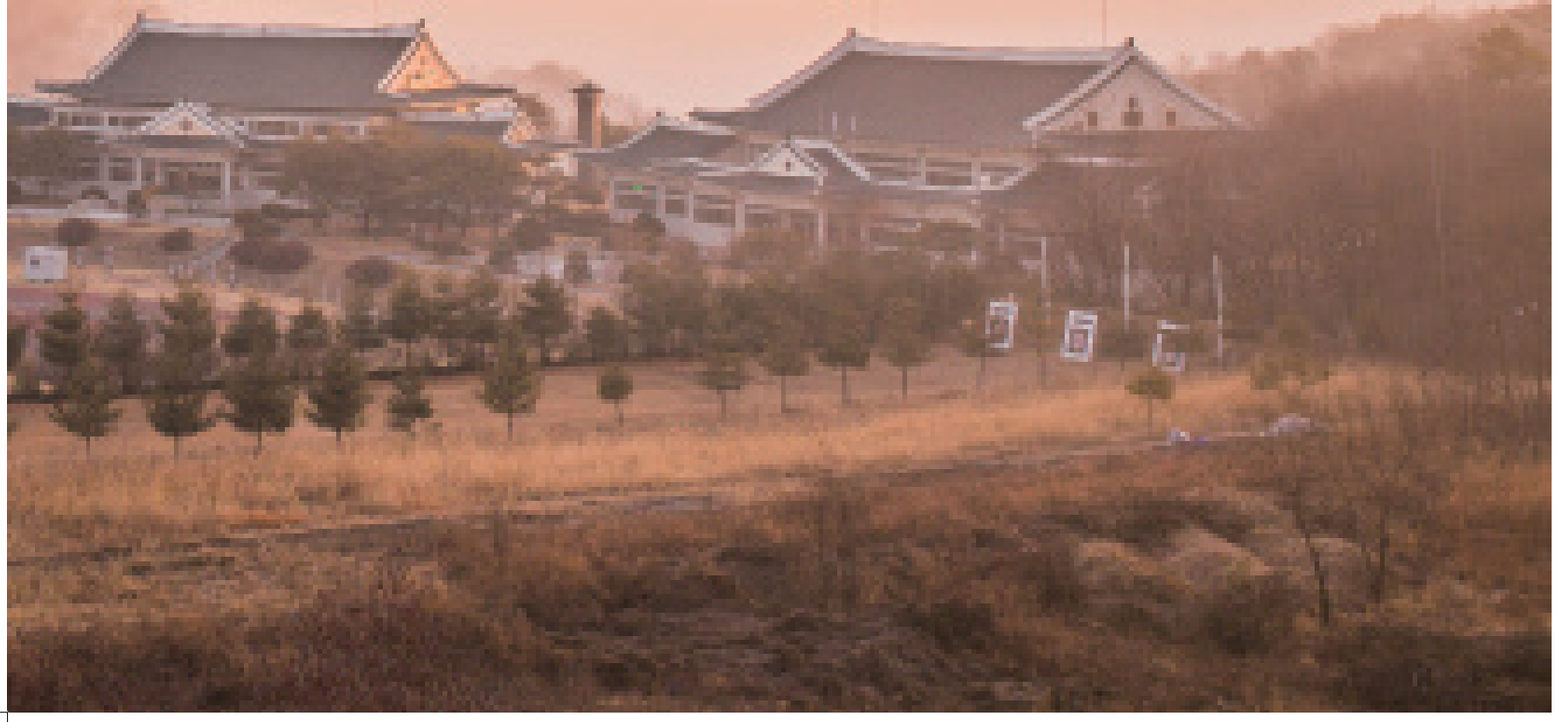
The Hidden Storage: Out of Sight, Out of MInd 14

Unraveling the Mystery of Underground Space at Chungmoo Hall 15

Surviving a Zombie Apocalypse in Changui Hall 16

Surviving a Zombie Apocalypse in the Chungmoo Hall Third Floor Washroom 17

Mr. Ganse's Hill and the Infamous GanHamDo Program 18



The HIDDEN Storage:
Out of Sight, Out of Mind

Every morning, we trot down the same road to Dasan and Chungmoo Hall, chatting amidst the colorful stream of students in hanbok. In the morning liveliness, we easily ignore the path that leads to the left of the hill. It is a path of mystery; taking it is definitely not a choice that many going through another busy day would take.

We headed toward the end of the mysterious road right after the 8th period, curious to find out where it would lead us. At the end of the track stood two single-story buildings. One was made of concrete with a tennis court on top; the other was green, seemingly covered with plastic walls. At the side of the green building lay some gadgets: a small plastic bowl, some rods and even a red, rusty head of a hammer. There was a narrow niche behind the building, so we decided to check out what mysteries it hid. The niche was dark and eerie, as if dark secrets lay within. The ground was damp and covered with moss, with spider webs covering every corner. A pigeon suddenly flew out of nowhere, leaving us in bewilderment.

Travelling deeper along the path, we found a rusty, wide open facade of the concrete building. Peeking in, we noticed some bizarre things: massive concrete pieces that seemed to fill whole room, old pipes covered in dust and moss, and some enigmatic construction materials thrust randomly into small open spaces.

Observing this, we were struck with numerous unanswered questions. Why was this place built? Why had this place become dilapidated? Despite its proximity with the Deokgo House and the English Center, most students and teachers were unaware of its existence. Only spider webs, moss, dust, and the lonely howling winds filled the now forgotten place.

Upon inquiry, we found out that the history of this place could be traced all the way back to the first year of our school. Although the purpose of the attic remains a mystery, we discovered that the place was originally used as a tennis court; the net and other necessary equipment were readily prepared. Physical Education classes and club activities had also been active here. Then, what rendered this place obsolete? According to some teachers in the PE department, there was no longer a need for the facility once an outdoor sports field was built next to the barbeque site. The basement of this building is currently used as storage space, while also functioning as an electrical power plant generating 22900 Volts, which explains the threatening warning signs and cement covering the area.

The hidden storage is now desolate, out of sight and out of mind. Though this place now seems like the best refuge in case of a zombie apocalypse, let's face it: abandoning a tennis court is highly uneconomical. It is, perhaps, our role to revamp the tennis court to its former vitality and activity: with sustained effort, we could reclaim the original purpose of the building. Renovating it into a well-managed, tidy facility could be the first step. Sports clubs could also start playing some games in this area—basketball, soccer, or even badminton. It is now time to bring the hidden storage back to sight, and back to mind.

Junior Writers
Kim Ga-Eun, Yoon Hyo-Seo



Unraveling the Mystery of the UNDERGROUND SPACE AT CHUNGMOO HALL

If your advisor's office is at either Dasan or Chungmoo Hall, you would probably visit these buildings on a daily basis. During the ten-minute break between classes, you might climb the stairs to get to the second floor, to the offices of several teachers. The third floor is also a popular destination for Dance Sports students or orchestra members, as it provides for an open space with attached mirrors on the walls. Undoubtedly, you would be readily familiar with the Dasan and Chungmoo Hall facilities, from the first floor to the third. But what about what lies underneath? Beneath Chungmoo Hall lies a small, wide room that only workers from the Administration Office are granted entry.





After getting permission from a manager at the Administration Office, we went down the stairs of the Chungmoo Hall and came upon a mysterious room. As the door creaked open, we were immediately struck by the distinct odor of cigarette smoke. The second thing we noticed were the number of tangled pipes that covered the walls. Adjacent to the pipes were enormous machines and switches that flickered furiously. One fascinating switch was labelled, 'Pond and Water Fountain'—it probably controlled the water flow of the fountains the Hall. The exit was, to our surprise, connected to the inner building of Chungmoo Hall on the first floor. This door is the familiar door near the female's restroom most would have seen, always shut.

We soon learned that the basement of Chungmoo Hall is a boiler room, where water is heated and distributed to different rooms of the building. The switches control the heating system, while the pipes assure that heat is transferred to rooms. They constitute the central heating system of the building. Managers from the Administration Office are in charge of heating the building and making local adjustments

These switches not only control the distribution of hot water through the pipes for heating, but also control water provision for other purposes, such as the water used in the fountain in front of Chungmoo Hall. According to the manager of the Administration Office, the school used to operate the fountain in its early years. Yet, KMLA's 3rd wavers saw the end of the splendid scenery, and the fountain has always been turned off since then. When asked if the fountain could possibly be re-operated, the manager cast doubtful glances—he doubted the switches would still work. There still remains a myriad of unanswered questions, but the underground floor is sure an intriguing place that begs for a visit by mischievous students.

Senior Writers
Lee Ji-In, Yang Soo-Jung



민혜 2017-12 최종.indd 15 2017-12-20 오후 4:02:07

Surviving a Zombie Apocalypse in Changui Hall

Total terror has descended on KMLA in the chaos of the zombie apocalypse. We present you with another perfect hideaway—the Changui Hall.

The Hall is high up on a steep hill, distant from any highway (highways attract an awful lot of zombies) or building, so the Changui Hall is not exactly the type of place where a zombie would decide to trespass. But let's say that they somehow do manage to climb up the steep hill and arrive at the building. You've somehow succeeded in attracting several zombies who are madly chasing you from behind. You hold no weapon, but even if you had one, it would have probably come to no use—there are way too many zombies.

First, we advise you to lock the entrance to the Changui Hall; the zombies will valiantly attempt to break in through the glass door, but hopefully they will hold long enough for you make your escape upstairs. Climb up the stairs, as high up as you can go, making sure to pick up some potential weapons on the way, anything from pieces of metal to knives from the kitchen. Then choose a room and lock yourself in. Familiarize yourself with your weapons in case the zombies successfully chase you this far. If you're lucky, the zombies will likely no longer be able to smell you, so they'll forget why they're there, get hungry, and walk away from Changui Hall to find another prey.

The zombies burst in, eagerly searching for you; eventually some locate your position and crawl towards you. Open the windows just in case you are cornered ,and you need an emergency escape. The wooden doors won't take too long to break down. Aim for their heads. Hit them as hard as you can. I hope you fight them off. And if you don't, well, becoming a zombie can't be that bad, can it? If you don't feel like becoming a cold-hearted moving corpse though, I strongly suggest you do whatever you can to get out of the building and throw yourself in the empty swimming pool at the right side of the Changui Hall.

The swimming pool looks long abandoned and forgotten. Its facilities appear to be as shockingly awful as you would never imagine—moss is literally everywhere, including the walls surrounding the pool. The freakish harmony of the green and the red of the corroded steel may send shivers down your spine, but I'm afraid you don't have much options left with a bunch of swarming, stinking bodies running towards you. There is a ladder down into the swimming pool—climbing down seems to be a great idea as zombies are utterly inflexible, nor do they have any tendons or body structures that allows for free movement. They will probably stumble upon the edge of the pool, trying to lower themselves in to no avail. Trying to climb down the ladder, they would probably miss their steps and die. Moreover, the scent of living flesh will be safely hidden, amidst the fishy stench of old metal that permeates the pool.

To no doubt, staying alive is your priority goal in a zombie apocalypse. We wish you the best of luck, with the heartfelt advice to make deft use of one of the hidden places of KMLA —the Changui Hall.

Junior Writers
Jeong Seo-Ryn, Nam Hyun-Soo

민혜 2017-12 최종.indd 16 2017-12-20 오후 4:02:07

Surviving a Zombie Apocalypse in Chungmoo Hall

Third floor Washroom

(The following is a fictional report)

Annual Sports Day has finally arrived. Students are grinning from ear to ear, chatting happily with each other. After lunch, they gather one by one in the schoolyard with their parents, when suddenly, a frantic cry is heard amidst the crowd. The Director of the Division of Student Affairs, Mr. Kim Myung-Soon, has been bitten by a strange creature. It is not long before a cohort of zombies comes into view, staggering and limping along the vast schoolyard. Students and parents flee in all directions, some escaping into the Dasan Hall, some frantically making their way up to the gym. Most are not aware of just the perfect hiding place, the 3rd floor bathroom of the Chungmoo Hall.

Located right next to the entrance of the third floor, the bathroom is seemingly disguised as a mere maintenance storage, its façade littered with several cleaning tools. However, tilt your eyes slightly to the side, and you come across a sign that reads, "ladies' room"—yes, you guessed it. It is a bathroom hidden from sight. This place holds a myriad of special advantages. First, it is the only restroom in a school building with a window. Looking out, one gets a bird's-eye view over the glistening roof down to the road leading to the archery grounds. If any of the zombies manage to climb up the roof, this is the perfect spot for an ambush. In addition, a washroom equipped with bottles of shampoo and conditioner ensures you a consistent supply of water, which would be crucial for long-term survival. The washroom is also equipped with a sturdy rubber tub, several tools that can suffice as effective armor or head-crushing weapons.

However, the true attraction lies a bit further below. Next to the high-rise girls' bathroom is a staircase reminiscent of a stealthy pathway leading to an eerie basement. Carefully stepping down the stairs, one comes across a scene very familiar yet quaint. The boys' restroom is not the usual white-and-gray or ivory-and-blue tiled restrooms found in the restrooms of other school buildings, but is embellished with black stone faucets and gently lighted mirrors. Apart from the neatly lined urinals and cubicles, this bathroom is equipped with a more established washroom as well. The sensibly lighted mirrors are the ultimate weapon; everything happening upstairs can be secretly monitored through its reflection. Only a slight portion of the mirror can be seen from upstairs, though. No zombies will dare take the risk to tumble down into such an unrevealed cache!

While the bathroom has been sitting in its corner ever since the building was built twenty years ago, few people have indulged in its secrets. "I had used the girls' bathroom often during practice, but I never knew there was a washroom!" exclaimed the 22nd waver Yim Jeong-A, who frequents the 3rd floor of the Chungmoo Hall to practice dancing. Observing closely, you will find the tiling of the floor much different, almost antique and wooden, compared to the floors of other bathrooms in the two main buildings. This is because restrooms of other buildings were constructed with the donation money received about 8 years ago, while the Chungmoo Hall third floor washroom has existed ever since the founder ordered the construction of the building. According to the book, 10 years of Korean Minjok Leadership Academy History, the founding father made students who dozed off during self-study periods and wash their faces here.

With the horde of zombies frantically chasing after you, we advise you to make the clever choice and choose the safest hideout—undoubtedly the bathroom of the 3rd floor Chungmoo Hall. Zombies, come if you dare!

Junior Writers
Jang Hyun-Bin, Youn Youn-Ji

민혜 2017-12 최종.indd 17 2017-12-20 오후 4:02:07

Mr. Ganse's Hill and the Infamous GANHAMDO PROGRAM

As we all know far too well, Korean Minjok Leadership Academy has a rigid penalty point system. Many resent the system despite its many contributions to a healthy school environment. Competition and the pressure of KMLA life threatens to reduce students to the mere instinct of survival, which creates two categories of students: the first being the typical model students, or so-called "naemis", who strictly adhere to the rules and submit themselves to the puritanical lifestyle, and those who would, for all its costs, indulge in the delights of a normal school life. Not getting penalty points has become a realistically impossible feat. But even that is not as difficult as getting enough reward points to pay for your treasured hours of sleep, feasting, and unrestrained friendship. But there are indeed, contrary to popular belief, many benefits to the system. For one thing, the school is able to keep their students from descending into chaos. Second, the school obtains a free-of-charge labor force at their disposal at the end of each quarter. The school is furthermore able to expand its settlement.

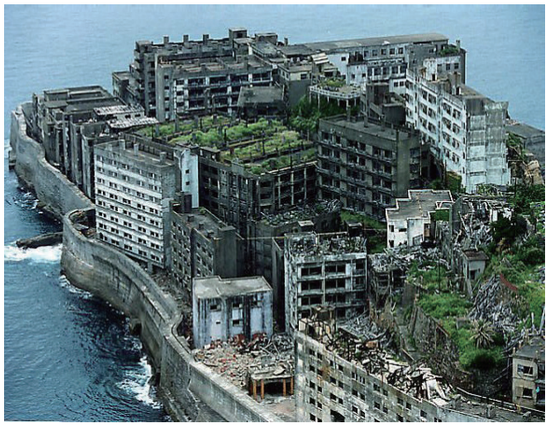
KMLA students are more than bored by mountains: we breathe the mountain air throughout the years, gaze at them when we're stuck in long lines at the cafeteria, climb them during morning exercise; in fact, our very dorm is built atop a mountain. Many students assume that there is nothing in these mountains apart from trees, deer, mosquitos, and Mr. Ganse. But what happens if you stray off course while you're going up the mountain during morning exercise? What else lies on the other side of the mountain?

One seemingly obvious but largely ignored fact is that mountains serve as natural walls. Sound is blocked at the face of a mountain which means that one traveling through the mountains may be perfectly unaware of the road on the other side. What lies on the dark side of the mountain? Very few students have charted this unknown frontier.

Throughout history the frontier was pushed back by some of the most uncomely people. Many of the American pioneers were in fact little more than outlaws and brigands. The same holds true for the mountains of KMLA. On weekly expeditions the "GoodbyeKMLA" group, an infamous group of students allegedly on the student guidance committee's blacklist of students to watch out for, ventures up and over these mountains in a desperate quest for reward points. These students were lured to work by broken promises that they would adequately be compensated with 4~5 reward points for their labor.



민혜 2017-12 최종.indd 18 2017-12-20 오후 4:02:22





GanHamDo is the jargon that these students use to talk about the region beyond the mountains. Decades after GoonHamDo, the "hell island" where thousands of Korean men were forcibly conscripted to do strenuous work during the Japanese rule, the GoodbyeKMLA group pays homage to this painful history and expands the frontier. For KMLA students, there is a special weekend program that is less painful, but perhaps comparably strenuous that provides a first-hand experience of these workers. In that aspect, the jargon 'GanHamDo' certainly does seem to be an apt term that epitomizes the arduous work expected from students.

Minjok Herald talked to 21st waver Jung Chan-Young, who has many friends (and memories) in the GoodbyeKMLA squad, and is also brave explorer of the KMLA mountains. Chan-Young testified to his GanHamDo memories with something between a laugh and an agonizing frown, providing us with brief overview of what the infamous program encompasses.

7:45 AM—Wake up and dash down towards Mr. Ganse's office, the crew head towards the headquarters

8:00 AM — Crew heads toward mountains with Mr. Ganse, with false hopes that their task will not be physically demanding

~12:00 PM—Move 96 stones to be used for the construction of a rodent house, for a "hearty" reward of two points

It seems the reward of two points is indeed tiny compared to the strenuous effort that has must be devoted into aiding Mr. Ganse's construction ambitions. However, an afternoon or two in the hill with a couple of friends could be a good chance to reinforce friendships. Next time your penalty points approach the danger limit, try visiting the secret place of GanHamdo—you will be more than grateful that our school has a hill large enough to provide you with endless hours of work.

Senior Writer
Jeon Hyung-Jun



민혜 2017-12 최종.indd 19 2017-12-20 오후 4:02:32

School Facilities and Possible **Dangers**

During times of heavy rainfall, the slope leading upwards to the Culture Center building overflows with water, creating a small flood. The problem originates from the broken drainage system built in the mountains on the side of the paved road. This is one of the many dangers that school facilities, worn out due to its harsh environment and poor maintenance, impose on the students. Most of the school buildings and facilities we use today have been built before 1996, when the school first opened. More than twenty years have passed, and the drainage systems, walls, and the ceilings have started to threaten the safety of KMLAians.



Some examples of school facilities in danger of deconstruction lie around in plain sight. One is a suspected woodpecker hole in the outer walls of the golf building. Another is a sinkhole, perhaps caused by a burst water pipe that may have washed out the soil underneath the asphalt. The hole is as wide as a foot, and deep enough for a person to step in and be buried up to the ankle. On the bridge in front of the Chungmoo Hall, there are several cracks as wide as two fingers between the handholds. They seem to have been partially mended with glue quite some time ago, but even the glue has worn away, exposing the gaps again. Although these damages may seem like minor annoyances at the moment, given the time, they could lead to potential disasters that can severely jeopardize the safety of students.

The Office of Administration is responsible for facility maintenance; its workers tend to minor management problems at a daily basis. Workers are often seen around school, mowing the grass or driving trucks around reconstruction sites. Better communication between the office and students would allow for a more efficient reconstruction of facilities that need the most tending.

The Chief of the School Administration, Mr. Choi Gyeong-Jong, has several remarks on this issue. "In my opinion, the blue tiles on most buildings in KMLA is the biggest problem right now. They are old and falling apart; if there is a strong wind, they might just blow off and drop to the floor. This can cause some serious injuries." He also commented on the difficulties concerning the reconstruction jobs that should take place. "You may think that we are not doing our job properly these days, but that isn't the case at all. Things can't simply be taken apart and put together again. For example, it costs at least a few million one to replace all of the blue tiles that cover the rooftops. Such financial base difficult to acquire, and considering the required manpower, it is definitely going to be a massive project to start and finish. So, what we do instead is, we fix the most dangerous facilities—those which are on the verge of falling apart. We have too much things we need to fix." Given such circumstances, it is indeed very difficult to renew all the worn-down facilities. Yet, we must keep in mind that if we continue to dismiss this crucial responsibility, and if we fail to renew the facilities that are in dire need of reconstruction, we will drive someone into danger in the near future.

It is clear that under current restrictions, a complete renovation or reconstruction of the main facilities is an unfeasible option. Temporary repairs of the most immediate concerns may be the best choice we have. However, students must be well-versed in the conditions of their school facilities, so as to readily point out any immediate dangers they see. Noticing these small things can create a big change. The slightest bit of attention can prevent a potential accident, and also encourage consistent facility maintenance to minimize jeopardy.

Junior Writer
Park Ji -Yoon

민혜 2017-12 최종.indd 20 2017-12-20 오후 4:02:37

New Quotas in Courses—Can We Learn for the Sake of Learning Itself?

The problem of the new quota is that it damages the **vital, distinctive quality of the education**

Many students recall the day of the 2nd semester course registration as a total frenzy—students sat before their computers and glared at the clock as it hit 12 o'clock, as the newly-made quotas in certain courses required the fastest click of the mouse. Course registrations in KMLA had until now allowed for thoughtful deliberation. Most courses had been quota-free—no one 'failed' to register for a desired course, except for few freshmen-mandatory courses. The sudden changes in the course registration system have flipped the situation.

Shortly before the course registration day, some teachers announced that they would set limitations to the number of students allowed to take their courses. These courses included AP Chemistry, AP U.S. Government & Politics, and Molecular Biology. The teachers explained that creating compact, interactive classes was the motive behind the change. Granted, the quota nicely tackles the deep-rooted problem of overpopulated classes, as it indubitably encourages more engaging class discussions with concentrated and enthusiastic students. This was, to an extent, exactly what students have been demanding from the school for so long. Yet, the new policy raises unexpected doubts over its efficacy as it sheds light on a number of concerns.

After the course registrations, there appeared some students who were rejected from taking their preferred courses. Among them, there were those who even failed to enroll themselves into the course of their majoring subjects. They were then forced to redesign their entire timetables due to the jumbled-up modules. The KMLA Announcement Facebook page flooded with complaints, as students argued that it was unjust to set sudden quotas to classes that have worked fine until now, and that they were not properly informed about the new changes beforehand. Not only that, there had been systematic errors in the registration homepage, which complicated the verification process of certain courses after registration. Desperate students personally visited the teachers to request extra slots in already full classes.

The problem of the new quota is that it damages the vital, distinctive quality of the education that KMLA offers to students. KMLA's school motto affirms academia for the sake of academia. KMLA have realized this value through granting freedom for students to choose among the wide variety of classes. KMLA's free grade/field policy and advanced college-level courses open for students have represented the opportunity to fully explore the field of one's academic interest. The quota set on advanced courses breaches student's right to enjoy the educational opportunities within KMLA, considering that 11th, 12th grade students often don't have a second chance to enroll in their desired course. Another concern is that many students were informed too late or were not accurately informed at all about the new quota. Students were not in a condition capable to make the corresponding adjustments in their timetable in a proactive manner.

The confusion and complaints following the new quota system indicates the dire need for communication between teachers and students. To reach the goal of genuinely-sought education, the ideal way to go would be to lift quotas altogether. Yet, since quota systems are inevitable for particular classes or teachers, notifying students through an organized announcement that specifies the course and quota beforehand would have given students time to plan alternatives. With this crucial step absent, students were left confused and devastated, some of whom were forced to take courses of no relevance to their interests—the last thing that should take place in a school that seeks academia driven from true interest.

Junior Writer
Choi In-Seo

민혜 2017-12 최종.indd 21 2017-12-20 오후 4:02:37

The New EOP Promotion, Guess WHO?

Undoubtedly one of the most debated policies both in and outside KMLA, the English Only Policy has recently gone through major reforms in its implementation. From the start of the semester, the Department of EOP announced a shift from a teacher-based reward and punishment system to a "carrot and stick" system with a focus on self-discipline and active learning. Whereas the former system issued penalty points immediately after violation, the new system provides the EOP violators a chance to redeem themselves through memorizing the English speech of the day.

Not only that, the Department of EOP implemented a guessing game promotion system where each class votes for the student that seems to be the designated EOP promoter, based on the frequency of using English. Compared to the previous incentive systems of teachers rewarding points to students who speak in English in front of them, this system rewards points based on consistent peer evaluation.

According to the Head of the Department of English Only Policy, 21st waver Ko Eun-Ji, the department revised the EOP policy because it felt that previous rules were ineffective when it came to voluntary enforcement. Students had rarely shown determination towards keeping the EOP, despite their awareness. Rather, former rules had only increased antipathy and criticism towards the EOP. The Department hopes to promote entertainment, self-discipline and educational benefits through its recent changes.



As the policy is new, it is still undergoing some minute changes. One change the department undertook was to giving a reward point to non-designated promoters who were voted as the promoter of the week, a point reduced from two points given to the actual, selected EOP promoters. Also, the department canceled reward points originally for classes that correctly guessed the promoter three consequent times, though classes that achieved a 100% participation rate is still rewarded a point. Furthermore, the department created a Facebook page, where EOP papers (short speeches which EOP violators are required to memorize) are uploaded daily.

The reformed EOP implementation policy was met with warm welcome from the students. Students commented that compared to former policies, the revised version provided practical benefits to the students. Furthermore, students commented that the new system better encouraged them to consistently speak in English, whereas the previous version only necessitated them to keep EOP in front of teachers. "EOP papers were worth memorizing due to its contents related to history or current global issues," one 21st waver added.

However, still there remains several implications that demand to be solved. One primary concern is that there is ample room to abuse the policy. As nothing can prevent each class from discussing who to vote for beforehand, some classes have previously decided to unanimously vote for the student with the most need of reward points instead of the student who spoke English most frequently. EOP promoters can also notify their classmates prior to voting so as to maximize reward points for themselves and the class. Because regulation is close to impossible, such abuse remains to be a chronic problem.

The Department of EOP should consistently discuss possible revisions to the new policy so as to encourage more students to speak in English while eliminating possibilities of misuse. As the forerunner of self-discipline and peer-discipline, the new EOP rules are expected to boost student-based policy implementations in other areas as well. May this change be the stepping stone for bigger changes.

Senior Writer
Bae Eun-gyul

민혜 2017-12 최종.indd 22 2017-12-20 오후 4:02:37

PENALTY POINTS-
Are they Heading the Right Way?



The purpose of penalty points and reward points is simple and clear—to educate students. Penalty points serve to punish students, as well as to make them reflect upon their wrongdoings. Reward points serve to compliment students who have contributed to bettering the school environment, as well as to encourage others to do the same. Yet, our reality has digressed far from these ideals, as the purpose of giving out penalty and reward points has become tainted.

The problem primarily lies in the fact that students have no room for reflection after receiving penalty points. Rather than looking back their past actions, they merely question, "Was my action that wrong in the first place?" Such attitude is derived from the dominant belief that the prosecution of penalty points purely depends on luck—how much of a good mood the dorm parent is in, or whether the timing was simply bad. Such belief prompts students to think, "I'll just be careful the next time," or "Today was a bad day," rather than "I should not repeat my actions."

Other problems also arise regarding the disproportionality of punishment to the severity of the wrongdoing. For example, students receive 2 points if they are late for morning exercise, and 3 points if they are absent. A late student could have woken up at 6: 31 AM, while an absent student could have woken up at 7:50 AM. Yet, their penalty points are only a point different. Resultantly, students who wake up late simply dismiss their duty and choose to go back to sleep rather than run to the gym—after all, the opportunity cost is only one penalty point. The educational effect of penalty points seems to be, sadly, defunct.

In the same context, students no longer consider reward points as a means to 'reward' good behavior, but rather as a means to reduce penalty points. They do whatever it takes to earn them, and take steps they otherwise would not have taken had the option been voluntary. For example, the 23rd executive council promised that if every student in an advisor class voted in the 24th student council election, all the class students would be rewarded a point. This announcement showed immediate effect, as the voter turnout rate reached an overwhelming 99% for the first time in KMLA history. This demonstrated the sad truth that students voted not because they had genuine interest in student councils, but because voting promised them lucrative favors. Not only that, the purpose of reward points has become tainted to the point where even teachers indiscriminately give out reward points; teachers let students clean their office, even when there is no need to clean. This is due to the severe unbalance in receiving reward points and penalty points. While penalty points are accumulated ever so easily with the myriad rules and regulations that constrict KMLA life, opportunities for reward points are rare. Thus, students, rather than regretting their bad behavior, simply struggle to nullify their points by cleaning offices over and over again.

Despite its systematic flaws, there still exists a necessity uphold the system. An anonymous 21st waver noted, "It is difficult to imagine our school without penalty points. I mean, who would go to morning exercise? Who would restrain themselves from eating ramen? Who would wear socks to the cafeteria? There would be utter chaos." Indeed, penalty points do serve to maintain order and discipline among students. The question is, to what extent we should let such rules dominate our lives. Students are losing their ability to lead self-disciplined lifestyles; they are losing the ability to choose for themselves what is right or wrong.

The value of education lies in making students learn from their mistakes. It is now time to stop and reflect whether this value is still valid in KMLA's penalty point system. The carrot and stick method is effective only when horses fear the stick, and crave the carrot. The same goes for our students as well.

Senior Writer
Ko Eun-ji

민혜 2017-12 최종.indd 23 2017-12-20 오후 4:02:37

Air is everywhere—we're just not aware.
The power to change is like air, too. It's always around us.
We just don't know how to grasp it.
Change—if not us, who? If not now, when?

